to destroy your freedom. But do not give them the tragic importance and make them feel that if a few papers shout, you are compelled to change the Constitution. Why give them the honour which they do not deserve?

The Prime Minister himself said that a major section of the Press is all right – their heart is sound. Then sit down with the Press representatives and discuss as to how the freedom which is being abused by a small section of the Press can be combated. I do not know which section the Prime Minister has in view; but supposing there is such a section, surely it cannot imperil the freedom of the general masses of the people. Lastly, I shall read out only one quotation, and that is also a judgment from the Supreme Court, in answer to what the Prime Minister said towards the end of his speech that after all you are making only small changes and it does not vitally affect the position at all. But this warning was sounded in the last paragraph of a judgment delivered by the Supreme Court in America – the danger signal has come and let no one ignore it if he wishes well of the country.

'Do the people of this land – in the providence of God, favoured, as they sometimes boast, above many others in the plenitude of their liberties – desire to preserve those so carefully protected by the First Amendment: liberty of religious worship, freedom of speech and of the press, and the right as free men to peaceably assemble and petition their Government for a redress of grievances? If so, let them withstand all beginnings of encroachment' – and here is a beginning of the encroachment of the liberty of the people in Free India – 'for the saddest epitaph which can he carved in memory of a vanished liberty is that it was lost because its possessors failed to stretch forth a saving hand while yet there was time.'